The Riddle of Steel

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/61100443.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Domestic Fluff, church camp au

Language:
English

Series:
Part 9 of The In-Between

Stats:
Published: 2024-12-05 Words: 707 Chapters: 1/1

The Riddle of Steel

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/61100443.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Domestic Fluff, church camp au

Language:
English

Series:
Part 9 of The In-Between

Stats:
Published: 2024-12-05 Words: 707 Chapters: 1/1

The Riddle of Steel

by TheSofterGentlerMe

Summary

Catra is watching a movie and decides it's time to say exactly how she feels about one of her metalworking customers, to Adora's everlasting sigh. A The In-Between story for the Camp Bright Moon series.

Notes

Shall we?

See the end of the work for more notes

"What is the riddle of steel?"

"I'll tell you what it is," Catra said to the movie playing on the television and ignored Adora's groan from next to her on the couch. "It's that idiots think they know about it based on some bullshit on the internet."

"Could we not?" Adora said as she paused the movie. "Just once?"

"No! I had some guy approach me today because he wants a custom knife. So I suggest what I always do…," Catra started to say before Adora cut her off.

"Which is 1095 carbon steel because it's easy to sharpen and care for, the tempering is easy and forgiving, and it's cheaper," Adora said, knowing the argument by heart because Catra had a tendency to go off on it, usually when someone came to her metalwork shop asking for some exotic steel.

"Yes!" Catra said, giving Adora a loving push. "You mock me but this guy wanted AMS 6491 steel!"

"The nerve!" Adora said with a grin.

"You don't have any idea do you, Doctor?" Catra said.

"My doctorate was concerned with the pure concepts of the mind and not with such physical things," Adora said, putting on a lofty expression that was ruined by her trying not to laugh.

"It's a fucking steel used in aerospace applications! I mean, come on! That stuff is so hard when tempered right, I'm pretty sure he wouldn't be able to ever sharpen it! It's used for *bearings in helicopter engines!* I could probably go online and find the exact forum he drools over that suggested it! I mean, yeah, I can probably make a knife out of it but fuck, why would you?" Catra said as she got up to go to the kitchen. Finn, their cat, followed at her heels making little noises that suggested they were starving and desperately needed snacks, even though their bowl was

currently full. Catra grabbed a beer out of the fridge for herself, grabbed a soda for Adora, and then dropped a little piece of salami down for Finn.

"You know that's not really good for them, right?" Adora said as Finn pounced on the treat.

"It's just a tiny bit for a treat," Catra said. "And you're trying to deflect the argument."

"Listen, I know how this is going to play out," Adora said as she spread her arms across the back of the couch. "You're going to complain about this guy the whole time because you still took the commission, then you're going to get a bunch of referrals off of it for the exact same thing, and you're going to end up upgrading the shop off the money from that alone."

Catra flopped down on the couch and handed Adora her soda as she said, "It's the principle of the matter. He's being stupid."

"I assume you quoted some over the top price?" Adora said as she cracked her soda open.

"Well, yeah," Catra said. "Even offered to get him an extra special big boy tactical sheath to go with it."

Adora rolled her eyes as she said, "Please tell me he didn't…"

"Of course he wants the matte black finish," Catra said with a snort. "Can't be special tactical mall ninja boy without the matte black blade finish."

Adora took a sip as she said, "How much did you quote him?"

Catra told her and Adora almost sprayed the soda out her nose.

"FOR A KNIFE!? AND HE SAID YES!?"

"But a super special knife with super special steel and of course he said yes," Catra said as she laughed. "How else am I supposed

to update the shop if I don't ask top dollar?"

Adora shook her head as she said, "I guess the riddle of steel is why someone would pay so damn much for a knife."

"Hey, it's a riddle that's going to make a big part of the mortgage payment next month," Catra said as she opened her beer and settled back into Adora's arms. "And he paid 50% up front as a deposit."

"So I assume I won't hear you complain about it anymore?" Adora said.

Catra leaned over to give her a kiss before saying, "Oh, you're so cute when you're wrongly optimistic."

End Notes

I was re-reading the fic Graduation from the Camp Bright Moon series and saw that there was a bit in there about Catra complaining about steel and how it was a bit of author voice because I have similar feelings. Then I thought, "You know, I could write a quick little bit for the In-Between series on this bit" and so here we go, a little slice-of-life Catradora. Also, if you don't know, the riddle of steel is a thing from the Conan the Barbarian movie from the 1980's (well, it's from the Conan stories but this particular reference is from that movie, see it for James Earl Jones and his hairstyle alone).

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!